1

ch1, ch2,Each chapter has four sections
The "Prudence" of ch1.1-2 about the Western model and Aristotle' "Prudence" leads to self-circulation, if not relying on some kinds of poiesis, ch1.3-4 metis, showing metis in Odysseus and not theorized by people after Socrates, Clausewitz, “"There is always friction in real war”
ch2 potential/situation in 《孙子兵法》--the warfare ; 《鬼谷子》In diplomacy;《韩非子》--In politics,

> (shi'), which is implied by that situation and can be made to play in one's favor.

1.1Western model or European schema：Goal, ideal, will→explaining the world

- We set up an ideal form (eidos), which we take to be a goal (telos), and we then act in such a way as to make it become fact.

"so here the problem: Is we still perpetuate(延续) those early Greek categories?or we no longer aiming a model with our eyes and explaining the world."
First I'll explain the Greek categories, and then I'll prove that the author thinks we haven't actually gotten rid of this Greek schema

1.2 ancient greek →the model/plato/Timaeus

- plato: "Plato's demiurgos(造物主) was bound to "keep his gaze fixed" on "imperishable being" so as to set it up as a paradigm and in order to realize its "shape and properties" (idea kai dunamis, Timaeus, 28a)"
- similar too ,just omit:"we can :executed in this way must of necessity be beauti ful." The craftsman of a city operates similarly, taking the great Demiurge as his model: "keeping his eyes turned toward" the absolute of essences, he endeavors to imbue the mores of his fellows with whatever he "perceives above" (Rep.,VI, 500c)"

And then the author compares Aristotle to plato's demiurgos(造物主), which the model is immanent, but...

1.21And Aristotle/EN: The model remains in sight even if it is immanent,the author thought.

- "As is well known, from Aristotle onward the world's status purely as a copy is dismissed. It is no longer believed that the material world is simply a copy according to the will of the demiurge"
- "The norm is no longer thought to be some intangible canon(ideal) that comes from outside to impress itself upon the world; instead, it is now regarded as the correct mean immanent in things"

1.23 Western paradigms have shaped contemporary worldviews, especially in science

0. "In fact, I regard this as one of the most characteristic moves made by the modern Western world (or maybe quite simply -the world as a whole if it has been standardized in accordance with the Western model"
   (So is contemporary China has the same situation,is we projects an ideal plan into the world? Like the Mathematical modeling course in college we take;)
1. Each projects upon the world an ideal plan that will then have to be incorporated into factual reality; incorporated? →First, they conceive of working "for the best"; next, they draw on

their "willpower" in order to impose their models upon reality.
2. Our inclination is to extend to everything this model"making, the principle of which was developed by science

1.4 Is these kinds of Western model works just as well for managing human situations and relations?
Or, to express that in terms of the two separate categories established by the Greeks: is the efficacy of the model that we recognize at the level of production (poesis) equally operative in the domain of action (praxis)
(or to express this way: Can one continue to operate as a technician when it comes to determining behavior?)

> difference-between-praxis-and-poiesis
> 1 In Aristotle's 'virtue ethics', actions are intentional and voluntary broadly speaking and a morally good action is an intentional, voluntary action done for its own sake and not with a view to a further end. So, for example, a morally good action would be one in which I returned a $50 bill to you simply because you had dropped it and were entitled to be re-possessed of your property: and not because you are good-looking and I reckon my chances for a date. The morally good action is done for its own sake and not for some end separate from it.
>
> 2 Poiesis, now, is different : the activity of practising a craft is an example of poeisis. Intentional, voluntary actions are involved but also, crucially, so is an end-product. In poeisis I am not doing an action or series of actions for its own sake; I aim to produce something - a pot, a vase, a box, a statue - as the end-product. These are quite separate from the actions that produced it.
> see in ethics - What is the difference between praxis and poiesis? - Philosophy Stack Exchange --- 伦理学 - 实践和诗歌有什么区别？ - 哲学堆栈交换

1.41 There might be some problems with Western model in "managing human situations"

- problem1:"For even if we have distinguished between the two, we may nevertheless have copied the one from the other (as we have indeed modeled action on production). Even when "things" become human affairs, we should still like to remain in the reassuring position of "technicians"-artisans or demiurges"
- problem2： Now, as we are well aware and as Aristotle was the first to recognize, although science may impose its rigor on things by understanding their necessary aspects and thereby· achieving technical efficacy, the situations in which our actions are performed are, for their part, indeterminate

The author will answer in more detail in the second part of ch1, in short, he proves that "prudence" is self-regressive if it cannot be explained by relying on some poiesis

1.5 conclusion for all above： The model remains out there on the horizon on which we fix our gaze. The ideal, up in the sky, is inaccessible.

2 "Prudence" (phronesis)
2.1 (Might "prudence" fill the gap between theory and practice?)

> Aristotle thought he had discovered a faculry for dealing with practice, a faculry that, taking over from theory, could fill in the gap. This abiliry was at once intellectual ("dianoetic") and directly linked with action and could thus mediate as was required. "Prudence" (phronesis) is the name traditionally given to this practical wisdom

2.2 difference-between-praxis-and-poiesis,see 1.4,
2.21 Here is the author's distinction about poiesis-praxis

- poiesis: Thales or an Anaxagoras, whose "difficult" and "divine" knowledge is "of no practical use
- praxis: it calculates and deliberates on the best thing to do. In this, it is complemented not only by "an accurate eye" but also by "an alert mind" or "good judgment" . It is exemplified not by scholars absorbed in their speculations, but in "the administrators of households and cities";-----Pericles

2.3 prudence?

- Given that such a person only deliberates on that which is contingent, prudence is not a science; nor is it an art, in the sense of a techne, since it is aimed at action (praxis) , not production.

```
<font color=red>for its own sake and not with a view to a further end</font>
加粗**文本**
```

2.31 **Definition and challenge from author**(vicious circle of "prudence")

- def：1.Prudence is a practical practical disposition, accompanied by correct reason with regard to what is good and what is bad for man" (Nic. Ethics, VI, 6).
- challenge from author：But what is the source of this "correct reason" that must accompany deliberation and serve as a norm, if not-precisely-science itself?
  2.32**Detail of argument**：
- 1. We know that, unlike Plato, Aristotle no longer believes either in the possibility of deducing the particular totally from the general or in action based on principles. So he can only define prudence by whatever is prudent: the criterion of prudence, which cannot be established by science, can only be provided by a man of whom it is generally said that "he is prudent."
- 2.Given that Aristotle no longer trusts the transcendence of the norm, by the same token he finds himself forced to the opposite extreme and condemned to empiricism.
  ……
  2.33 so the **conclusion**：
- For, in the absence of any essence in relation to which it can be defined, prudence can only be discerned（辨别） through the existence of remarkable individuals

2.4 **Prudence/cleverness** and **Cleverness is dismissed**

- the "advantage" for which the **prudent** man aims is not his own personal profit, but profit for the community; ultimately, he is concerned for the city; see Nic. Ethics, III);
- This is shown in particular by the way in which Aristotle opposes what is prudent to what is clever . Whereas cleverness is an ability to combine the most efficacious means, regardless of the quality of the end, prudence, for its part, is concerned about that end. Prudence, an ethical take on cleverness, is always directed toward the good; and pure "cleverness" is set aside.

3 The cunning intelli gence of the Greeks--metis

3.1what is metis,the meaning

> Vernant tell us that metis combines "flair, sagacity, foresight, adaptability, pretense, resourcefulness, vigilance, opportunism."..
> Odysseus, clever Odysseus with a thousand tricks up his sleeve, is the hero most richly endowed with metis: he is polumetis.
> (omit)And Zeus himself starts off by swallowing the goddess Metis in order to absorb her wisdom and to be sure of avoiding all the traps that could bring about his downfall in dealings with both gods and men.

3.11 what is metis,further explaination--

> Metis is characterized in particular by the fact that, through some more or less fundamental maneuver and by making the most of circumstances, it is possible to win out over brute strength
> Odysseus is so devious that he can foil the attacks of any opponent and ensnare/ɪnˈsneə(r)/ him with his eloquence/ˈeləkwəns/.

3.12metis is not yet free from the magic of myth.

> it is at once technical and magical.
> techni:It is Athena, after all, who presides/prɪˈzaɪd/ over metis. Its technical dimension is unmistakable in both hunting and fishing, and is illustrated by skill in the art of steering a boat
> magical: Athena's or Medea's machinations, one fears their philters and their tricks

3.13 find no theory related to metis(墨提斯/智慧之神)

> metis foils any attempt to stabilize its identity on the basis provided by Being or God, to which Greek thought is devoted. Only the Sophists made an initial attempt to open philosophical intelligence up to the disturbing features of metis,
> "metis remained outside what was to become the field of Greek science" (in fact, the very word "metis " soon disappeared from the Greek language).

4 warfare
4.1The failure to produce a theory of warfare
4.11The failure to produce a theory of warfare. why?

> When it attempted to systematize the material data, it either reduced superiority in warfare simply to numerical data (thereby making warfare depend on mathematical laws) or else it proceeded by way of a geometrification of one of the crucial factors (for instance, on the basis of the angle of the army's thrust in relation to its basic position-see von Biilow-or according to the theory of its internal alignments; see De Jomini).

4.12 result: so the only way to account for military successes was to invoke the natural dispositions and "genius" of those in volved

4.2 how Clausewitz himself, wishing to progress beyond such dead-ends?

> He begins by conceiving warfare according to a "model" form, as an ideal and pure essence, "absolute warfare." Then he goes on to contrast this model to "real" warfare, as modified by the facts of reality.

4.21 The problem of this dilution/daɪˈluːʃn/稀释.(Clausewitz still cannot break free from the theory-practice notion.)

> 1.warfare implies a limitless use of force that, logically, tends to lead it, in reaction to attack, to extremes {that envisaged total destruction}
> 2.,which constitutes the essence of warfare, is always to some extent attenuated(dilution) in reality
>
> 3. so what is the nature of "these nonconducive circumstances" that block the "complete realization" of the principle of warfare?

4.3 so he conclude from 4.2

> The defining characteristic of warfare is precisely the inevitable distance that separates the reality of it from its model. In short, to think about warfare is to think about the extent to which it is bound to betray the ideal concept of it.

4.4 so whtat conditions are necessary for a science of the conduct of warfare to be possible?
solution1 failed： "law," is inapplicable/ˌɪnəˈplɪkəbl/ to the conduct of warfare because of the changeable and variable nature of the phenomena involved

solution2：
a matter of a "method," in the sense not of a logic but of "an average probability, judging by similar cases."; "normally" adapted, which, having progressively become assimilated, becomes "customary," a "routine," and so on. ————→(it's bad aspect)"routine or an average probability, " becomes increasingly inappropriate as one progresses from the level of tactics to that of strategy.

if two above all have it's disadvantage, then Clausewits explains:

> "Clearly then, in action such as warfare, in which a plan based on general conditions is so often upset by particular and unexpected phenomena, it is necessary to leave far more, generally, to talent and to rely less than in any other domain on theoretical recommendations."

4.5why the ideal model intended as a guide for action fails?

> "Friction:' a "machine"(the reality is not a perfect model/machine, it has friction)
>
> The author explains it in detail:
> 1.however well "oiled" the military "machine" may be, countless points of friction neverthe less remain, and, however minimal, these eventually produce sufficient resistance to throw the action off course.
> 2."In warfare everything is simple" (in the initial plan), "but the simplest of things proves difficult" (in practice).

4.6 conclusion ch1： Unsuitable for model making

1. "prudence," the ethical interpretation of the metis of the ancient heroes, represented the first link. ----which had failed
2. (warfare).----which had failed too ("to note the extent to which the ideological schemata of the arts and sciences are ill-suited to this activity(warfare)")

ch2.5-8 Relying on the Propensity of Things

5 no longer had to entertain the theory-practice relationship(2), but to Rely on the inherent potential(3)

> 2 the Chinese sage never conceived of a contemplative activity that was pure knowledge (theorein) , possessing an end in itself, or that itself represented the supreme end (happiness) and was altogether disinterested
> 2 For him, the "world" was not an object of speculation; it was not a matter of "knowledge"

> on the one hand and "action" on the other; it just disregarded the theory-practice relationship
> 3 Rather than set up a model to serve as a norm for his actions, a Chinese sage is inclined to concentrate his attention on the course of things in which he finds himself involved in order to detect their coherence and profit from the way that they evolve.
> 3 for example: The proverb runs as follows: "How ever acute one's intelligence may be, it is better to rely on the potential inherent in the situation"; "even with a mat tock and a hoe to hand, it is better to wait for the moment of ripening" (MZ, II, A, 1)

5.1 The notion of the potential of a situation

> Two notions thus lie at the heart of ancient Chinese strategy, forming a pair: on the one hand, the notion of a situation or configuration (xing),as it develops and takes shape before our eyes (as a relation of forces);on the other hand, and counterbalancing this, the notion of potential (shi'), which is implied by that situation and can be made to play in one's favor.
>
> for example: (Li Quan) glosses, if the troops obtain the strategic potential, "then cowards are brave"; if they lose it, "then the brave are cowardly."
>
> > Describe shi in Sun Tzu's Art of War《孙子兵法》ch5势篇
> >
> > 激水之疾，至于漂石者，势也(1)；鹰鸟之疾，至于毁折者，节也(2)。是故善战者，其势险，其节短(3)。势如彍弩，节如发机(4)。纷纷纭纭，斗乱而不可乱也；浑浑沌沌，形圆而不可败也(5)。乱生于治，怯生于勇，弱生于强(6)。治乱，数也(7)；勇怯，势也(8)；强弱，形也(9)。

5.2 obtain the strategic potential in (SZ):

> The first is that of a moral potential: "When the general despises the enemy and his troops are glad to fight, their ardor soars as high as the skies and their energy is like a hurricane."
> The second is that of a topographical potential: when the pass is constricted and the path is narrow, "a single man can guard the place and even a thou sand men could not force their way through."
> The third is that of a potential through "adaptation"

6 evaluating the situation/ assessment of the forces
《孙子兵法》 ch1计篇 七计

故经之以五事，校之以计，而索其情(1)：一曰道(2)，二曰天(3)，三曰地(4)，四曰将(5)，五曰法(6)。道者，令民与上同意也(7)，故可以与之死，可以与之生，而不畏危(8)；天者，阴阳、寒暑、时制也(9)；地者，远近、险易、广狭、死生也(10)；将者，智、信、仁、勇、严也(11)；法者，曲制、官道、主用也(12)。凡此五者，将莫不闻，知之者胜，不知者不胜(13)。故校之以计，而索其情，曰：主孰有道(14)？将孰有能(15)？天地孰得(16)？法令孰行(17)？兵众孰强(18)？士卒孰练(19)？赏罚孰明(20)？吾以此知

6.1
"Once the assessment of what is profitable [made on the basis of the above seven points] has been agreed upon, one can deduce the potential of the situation, which can be helpful outsided[outside' meaning beyond the rules of evaluation, on the terrain/təˈreɪn/ where operations are to take place]."
~~the author also said "moving from an assessment of the forces in confrontation to the potential that can be deduced from that assessment, is of central importance."~~
~~Now circumstances are no longer conceived only (indeed, at all) as "that which surrounds" (circum-stare),~~
~~Instead, it is through those very circumstances that potential is released, the potential, precisely, of the situation.~~
Conclusion: potential is circumstantial-it only exists thanks to the circumstances and vice-versa (so it is the potentiality of the circumstances that one needs to exploit)

6.2 European side vs Chinese ("shi")

> (On Warfare, II, 2):

> 1. The (Western) theorists of warfare "strove after determinate quantities," "whereas in war all calculation has to be made with varying quantities";
> 2. they only took into consideration "material forces," "while all action in war is permeated by spiritual and moral forces and effects";
> 3. "they only took into consideration the action of one of the combatants, while war entails a constant state of reciprocal action. "
>
> (1) The Chinese consider the potential of a situation to be variable; it cannot be determined in advance, since it proceeds from continuous adaptation;
> (2) the assessments from which the potential is deduced are adept at combining spiritual and physical features (taking into account both the morale on which the cohesion of the troops depends and also material questions of organization and weaponry);
> (3) the dimension of reciprocity lies at the very heart of what constitutes the potential of a situation (whatever is disadvantageous to the enemy is, by the same token, advantageous to oneself), and, in China, warfare is quite naturally thought of in terms of interaction and polarity, just as any other process is.

6 A similar systematic evaluation is required In diplomacy(外交)

> a sage "spins," as a ball would, to find the "adequate" position in any situation. Because his strategy never limits itself to a single level, never commits him to any plan, it is fathomless: "fathomless" to others and "inexhaustible" to himself.(is this called a sage? 孟子)

《鬼谷子》ch10 谋篇第十

夫仁人轻货①，不可诱以利，可使出费②；勇士轻难③，不可惧以患，可使据危④；智者达于数⑤，明于理，不可欺以不诚，可示以道理，可使立功，是三才也⑥。故愚者易蔽也，不肖者易惧也，贪者易诱也，是因事而裁之⑦。故为强者，积于弱也；为直者，积于曲也⑧；有余者，积于不足也。此其道术行也⑨。

【注释】

①轻货：轻视财物。

For it is definitely that potential that "separates" "profit" from "harm," since it is the factor that, through its "authority, " influences how the situation will evolve

(image of round stones rolling down a slope and to the conclusion that the potential of the situation makes it impossible that things "should be otherwise.)

8

8.1In politics. the potential is a position of authority. the emperor own it(here are examples)

> 1. A perfect tyrant does not need to be present
>
> > It is perfectly possible for him to devote himself to his task without leaving his palace or without even occupying his position there. He can perfectly well withdra "to the sea side" yet still keep control of his mechanism of power and continue to direct everything. In other words, the position of authority needs to be occupied not in person, but only technically.
> > The two levers of fear and self-interest, the one repressive, the other an incentive, on their own constituted a device that enabled the prince to manipulate human nature as he pleased (HFZ, chap. 7, "Er bing").

> 而赏异也，诛毋谒而罪同③。言会众端，必揆之以地，谋之以天，验之以物，参之以人。四征者符，乃可以观矣。参言以知其诚，易视以改其泽④，执见以得非常。一用以务近习，重言以惧远使。举往以悉其前，即迩以知其内，疏置以知其外。握明以问所暗，诡使以绝黩泄⑤。倒言以尝所疑，论反以得阴奸。设谏以纲独为，举错以观奸动。明说以诱避过，卑适以观直谄。宣闻以通未见，作斗以散朋党。深一以警众心，泄异以易其虑。似类则合其参，陈过则明其固。知罪辟罪以止威，阴使时循以省衷⑥。渐更以离通比。下约以侵其上：相室⑦，约其廷臣；廷臣，约其官属；军吏⑧，约其兵士；遣使⑨，约其行介；县令，约其辟吏⑩；郎中⑪；约其左右；后姬，约其宫媛。此之谓条达之道。言通事泄，则术不行。

> 明主，其务在周密。是以喜见则德偿，怒见则威分。故明主之言隔塞而不通，周密而不见。故以一得十者②，下道也；以十得一者，上道也。明主兼行上下，故奸无所失。伍、闾、连、县而邻③，谒过赏，失过诛。上之于下，下之于上，亦然。是故上下贵贱相畏以法，相诲以利。民之性，有生之实，有生之名。为君者有贤知之名，有赏罚之实。名实俱至，故福善必闻矣。

8.2 Merit versus position

> Two criteria are possible: on the one hand, personal merit; on the other, the Merit versus position occupation of this position of authority. And in the legalists' view, the one excludes the other (HFZ, chap. 40, "Nan shi").
> Either you rely on your personal qualities and exhaust yourself in your efforts, in which case the result is always precarious (HFZ, chap. 49, "Wu du"), or else you rely solely on that position of authority, allowing yourself to be "carried" along by it, as a dragon is by the clouds (see Shen Dao), in which case all orders are unfailingly executed (HFZ, chap. 28)

Finally:
The author proposed the concepts of "shi" and "ji." "JI" refers to the evaluation and prediction that takes place outside the battlefield, considering both the spiritual and material aspects. For example, in Thucydides' "History of the Peloponnesian War," the fear that Sparta had towards Athens was one of the reasons that led to the outbreak of war. In practical warfare, diplomacy, and politics, generals, diplomats, and emperors understand how to "顺势而为"